PAINTING TRADITIONS

PAINTING READING AXES → MURAL TECHNIQUE FIREWALL → BAGH IDENTIFICATION CARD → SOUTHERN MURAL SURVIVAL → FORMAT-PATRONAGE SHIFT → MUGHAL ATELIER CHANGE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◇ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g2 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 PAINTING READING AXES

PAINTING READING AXES | ROCK, WALL, PAGE, ALBUM OR CANVAS | ENGRAVING, DRY PLASTER, WASH OR PRINT | MONASTERY, COURT, MARKET OR COMMUNITY | COLLECTIVE, PRIVATE OR MASS | MUST REMEMBER | PAINTING CHRONOLOGY RUNS FROM ROCK ART AND AJANTA-BAGH MURALS | PALLAVA-CHOLA WALLS, PALA AND JAIN MANUSCRIPTS, MUGHAL ATELIERS, REGIONAL

CORE CLAIM

- FORMAT → rock, wall, page, album or canvas
- TECHNIQUE → engraving, dry plaster, wash or print
- PATRON → monastery, court, market or community

MECHANISM

- AUDIENCE → collective, private or mass
- MUST REMEMBER: Painting chronology runs from rock art and Ajanta-Bagh murals through
- Pallava-Chola walls, Pala and Jain manuscripts, Mughal ateliers, regional miniatures,

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- Company-bazaar publics and nationalist modern responses.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Pallava-Chola walls, Pala and Jain manuscripts, Mughal ateliers, regional miniatures,.

01

STAGE 01 MURAL TECHNIQUE FIREWALL

MURAL TECHNIQUE FIREWALL | PREPARED PLASTER, PIGMENT AFTER DRYING | TRUE FRESCO | PIGMENT INTO WET PLASTER | DO NOT TRANSFER AJANTA'S LABEL AUTOMATICALLY | TECHNIQUE MUST BE SITE-SPECIFIC

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
AJANTA → prepared plaster, pigment after drying	BAGH → do not transfer Ajanta's label automatically	AJANTA → prepared plaster, pigment after drying
TRUE FRESCO → pigment into wet plaster	RULE → technique must be site-specific	TRUE FRESCO → pigment into wet plaster

CORE CLAIM

- AJANTA → prepared plaster, pigment after drying
- TRUE FRESCO → pigment into wet plaster

MECHANISM

- BAGH → do not transfer Ajanta's label automatically
- RULE → technique must be site-specific

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- AJANTA → prepared plaster, pigment after drying
- TRUE FRESCO → pigment into wet plaster

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: BAGH → do not transfer Ajanta's label automatically.

02

STAGE 02 BAGH IDENTIFICATION CARD

BAGH IDENTIFICATION CARD | BAGHNI RIVER, DHAR DISTRICT | CAVE 4 | RANG MAHAL, JATAKA MURALS | BAGH PAINTINGS GENERALLY | NO MODERN-FORM EQUIVALENCE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
SITE → Baghni river, Dhar district	HALLISALASYA → Bagh paintings generally	SITE → Baghni river, Dhar district
CAVE 4 → Rang Mahal, Jataka murals	LIMIT → no modern-form equivalence	CAVE 4 → Rang Mahal, Jataka murals

CORE CLAIM

- SITE → Baghni river, Dhar district
- CAVE 4 → Rang Mahal, Jataka murals

MECHANISM

- HALLISALASYA → Bagh paintings generally
- LIMIT → no modern-form equivalence

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- SITE → Baghni river, Dhar district
- CAVE 4 → Rang Mahal, Jataka murals

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: HALLISALASYA → Bagh paintings generally; LIMIT → no modern-form equivalence.

03

STAGE 03 SOUTHERN MURAL SURVIVAL

SOUTHERN MURAL SURVIVAL | KANCHIPURAM AND PANAMALAI | SITTANAVASAL BRIDGE | VIJAYA CHOLISHWARAM AND BRIHADISHVARA | LATER SUPERIMPOSITION

PALLAVA → Kanchipuram and Panamalai → PANDYA → Sittanavasal bridge → CHOLA → Vijaya Cholishwaram and Brihadishvara → NAYAKA → later superimposition

CORE CLAIM

- PALLAVA → Kanchipuram and Panamalai
- PANDYA → Sittanavasal bridge

MECHANISM

- CHOLA → Vijaya Cholishwaram and Brihadishvara
- NAYAKA → later superimposition

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- PALLAVA → Kanchipuram and Panamalai
- PANDYA → Sittanavasal bridge

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CHOLA → Vijaya Cholishwaram and Brihadishvara; NAYAKA → later superimposition.

04

STAGE 04 FORMAT-PATRONAGE SHIFT

FORMAT-PATRONAGE SHIFT | MONUMENTAL WALL | INSTITUTIONAL SPONSOR | PORTABLE DEVOTIONAL PAGE | PRIVATE CONNOISSEURIAL PATRON | MARKET AND PUBLIC

MONUMENTAL WALL → institutional sponsor → MANUSCRIPT → portable devotional page → ALBUM → private connoisseurial patron → PRINT / CANVAS → market and public

CORE CLAIM

- MONUMENTAL WALL → institutional sponsor
- MANUSCRIPT → portable devotional page

MECHANISM

- ALBUM → private connoisseurial patron
- PRINT / CANVAS → market and public

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- MONUMENTAL WALL → institutional sponsor
- MANUSCRIPT → portable devotional page

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ALBUM → private connoisseurial patron; PRINT / CANVAS → market and public.

05

STAGE 05 MUGHAL ATELIER CHANGE

MUGHAL ATELIER CHANGE | NARRATIVE MANUSCRIPT SERIES | COLLABORATIVE KARKHANA | ALBUM PORTRAIT AND NATURAL HISTORY | MOBILE TRAINED ARTISTS

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
AKBAR → narrative manuscript series	JAHANGIR → album portrait and natural history	AKBAR → narrative manuscript series
WORKSHOP → collaborative karkhana	CONTINUITY → mobile trained artists	WORKSHOP → collaborative karkhana

CORE CLAIM

- AKBAR → narrative manuscript series
- WORKSHOP → collaborative karkhana

MECHANISM

- JAHANGIR → album portrait and natural history
- CONTINUITY → mobile trained artists

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- AKBAR → narrative manuscript series
- WORKSHOP → collaborative karkhana

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: JAHANGIR → album portrait and natural history; CONTINUITY → mobile trained artists.

06

STAGE 06 REGIONAL MINIATURE MAP

REGIONAL MINIATURE MAP | BANI THANI, NIHAL CHAND | BOLD LINE AND INTENSE COLOUR | LYRICAL NATURALISM | SATURATED PERSIANATE COURT IDIOM

KISHANGARH → Bani Thani, Nihal Chand

BASOHLI → bold line and intense colour → GULER / KANGRA → lyrical naturalism → DECCAN → saturated Persianate court idiom

CORE CLAIM

- KISHANGARH → Bani Thani, Nihal Chand
- BASOHLI → bold line and intense colour

MECHANISM

- GULER / KANGRA → lyrical naturalism
- DECCAN → saturated Persianate court idiom

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- KISHANGARH → Bani Thani, Nihal Chand
- BASOHLI → bold line and intense colour

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: GULER / KANGRA → lyrical naturalism; DECCAN → saturated Persianate court idiom.

07

STAGE 07 SOUTH INDIAN DISTINCTION

SOUTH INDIAN DISTINCTION | GESSO RELIEF AND GOLD COATING | SEPARATE COURT TRADITION | DEVOTIONAL ICON | SHARED BROAD PURPOSE | SHARED REGION IS NOT IDENTITY

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
TANJORE → gesso relief and gold coating	DEVOTIONAL ICON → shared broad purpose	TANJORE → gesso relief and gold coating
MYSORE → separate court tradition	TRAP → shared region is not identity	MYSORE → separate court tradition

CORE CLAIM

- TANJORE → gesso relief and gold coating
- MYSORE → separate court tradition

MECHANISM

- DEVOTIONAL ICON → shared broad purpose
- TRAP → shared region is not identity

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- TANJORE → gesso relief and gold coating
- MYSORE → separate court tradition

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DEVOTIONAL ICON → shared broad purpose; TRAP → shared region is not identity.

08

STAGE 08 COLONIAL PUBLIC MATRIX

COLONIAL PUBLIC MATRIX | EUROPEAN PATRON AND DOCUMENTATION | COMMERCIAL PUBLIC | RAVI VARMA | ACADEMIC REALISM AND PRINTS | BENGAL SCHOOL | NATIONALIST WASH IDIOM

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
COMPANY → European patron and documentation	RAVI VARMA → academic realism and prints	COMPANY → European patron and documentation
BAZAAR / KALIGHAT → commercial public	BENGAL SCHOOL → nationalist wash idiom	BAZAAR / KALIGHAT → commercial public

CORE CLAIM

- COMPANY → European patron and documentation
- BAZAAR / KALIGHAT → commercial public

MECHANISM

- RAVI VARMA → academic realism and prints
- BENGAL SCHOOL → nationalist wash idiom

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- COMPANY → European patron and documentation
- BAZAAR / KALIGHAT → commercial public

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RAVI VARMA → academic realism and prints; BENGAL SCHOOL → nationalist wash idiom.

09

STAGE 09 FOLK-PAINTING DISCRIMINATOR

FOLK-PAINTING DISCRIMINATOR | MITHILA LINE-AND-FILL | WHITE GEOMETRIC FIGURES ON EARTH GROUND | ODISHA CLOTH OR PALM LEAF | NARRATIVE TEXTILE PROCESS | CLOSE DISTINCTION | AJANTA IS MORE SAFELY DESCRIBED AS FRESCO SECCO OR

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
MADHUBANI → Mithila line-and-fill	PATTACHITRA → Odisha cloth or palm leaf	CLOSE DISTINCTION: Ajanta is more safely described as fresco secco or tempera than true wet fresco
WARLI → white geometric figures on earth ground	KALAMKARI → narrative textile process	Bani Thani is Kishangarh, while Basohli, Guler, Kangra, Deccani, Tanjore and Mysore retain distinct identifiers.

CORE CLAIM

- MADHUBANI → Mithila line-and-fill
- WARLI → white geometric figures on earth ground

MECHANISM

- PATTACHITRA → Odisha cloth or palm leaf
- KALAMKARI → narrative textile process

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Ajanta is more safely described as fresco secco or tempera than true wet fresco
- Bani Thani is Kishangarh, while Basohli, Guler, Kangra, Deccani, Tanjore and Mysore retain distinct identifiers.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Ajanta is more safely described as fresco secco or tempera than true wet fresco; Bani Thani is Kishangarh, while Basohli, Guler, Kangra, Deccani, Tanjore and Mysore retain distinct identifiers.

10

STAGE 10 SURVIVAL-BIAS LADDER

SURVIVAL-BIAS LADDER | SURVIVING OBJECT | DIRECT EVIDENCE | LITERARY REFERENCE | PRACTICE WAS KNOWN | MISSING WALL | PRESERVATION GAP | DO NOT EQUATE SURVIVAL WITH PRODUCTION

SURVIVING OBJECT → direct evidence

LITERARY REFERENCE → practice was known → MISSING WALL → preservation gap → VERDICT → do not equate survival with production

CORE CLAIM

- SURVIVING OBJECT → direct evidence
- LITERARY REFERENCE → practice was known

MECHANISM

- MISSING WALL → preservation gap
- VERDICT → do not equate survival with production

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Survival scarcity does not prove low original production, shared Persianate resources do not
- make every miniature Mughal, and folk or tribal traditions require region, support, community and function.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → do not equate survival with production.

11

STAGE 11 PAINTING ANSWER SPINE

PAINTING ANSWER SPINE | FORMAT AND TECHNIQUE | PATRON AND AUDIENCE CHANGE | NAMED SCHOOL ON COMMON AXES | SURVIVAL, ATTRIBUTION AND CURRENT STATUS

DEFINE → format and technique → TRACE → patron and audience change → COMPARE → named school on common axes → QUALIFY → survival, attribution and current status

CORE CLAIM

- DEFINE → format and technique
- TRACE → patron and audience change

MECHANISM

- COMPARE → named school on common axes
- QUALIFY → survival, attribution and current status

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- DEFINE → format and technique
- TRACE → patron and audience change

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COMPARE → named school on common axes; QUALIFY → survival, attribution and current status.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT | NO URGENT CURRENT-STATUS CORRECTION IS REQUIRED FOR THIS TOPIC'S | TREATING THE PAUCITY OF SURVIVING PALLAVA MURALS AS PROOF | TREATING MUGHAL MINIATURE PAINTING AS CONTINUOUS WITH, RATHER THAN | TREATING THE BENGAL SCHOOL AS MERELY "TRADITIONAL-STYLE" PAINTING. | TREATING MUGHAL, RAJASTHANI, PAHARI AND DECCANI AS ISOLATED ETHNIC | MODERN HISTORY OWNS THE SWADESHI MOVEMENT AND THE POLITICAL | INDIAN SOCIETY OWNS THE SOCIO-ECONOMIC CONDITIONS OF PRACTISING

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- No urgent current-status correction is required for this topic's core
- NOT: Treating the paucity of surviving Pallava murals as proof mural
- NOT: Treating Mughal miniature painting as continuous with, rather than a
- NOT: Treating the Bengal School as merely "traditional-style" painting.

ADVANCED DEBATE

- NOT: Treating Mughal, Rajasthani, Pahari and Deccani as isolated ethnic
- NOT: Modern History owns the Swadeshi movement and the political
- NOT: Indian Society owns the socio-economic conditions of practising
- This file's format-patronage method is reusable wherever another

LEGACY / NUANCE

- Foundation companion: basic/07 Painting-Traditions.md.
- 00 Master-Framework.md Section 4 — the evidence hierarchy, applied
- CAUTION: Cross-links: Topic 03 (Pallava/Chola mural evidence supporting
- Verified against Nitin — pdf , PDF pp. 309-377 directly (chapter

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels